

GOOGLE PHOTOS

With Google Photos, it's evident that Google plans to bridge the gap between cloud storage, image hosting and image sharing services. Giving stiff competition to Flickr, Google Photos packs some of the most powerful features that have yet to be introduced in any other image hosting application. Though most of the features and services bundled with this application have been discussed about for a while, we'll move beyond basics and dig into some of the advanced features of this application.

Search for people, places and objects

It's Google, so the search is bound to be good. But, it's much better than what you'd imagine. If you're looking for all photos of your dog, a simple search for "dog" in the search bar will get what you want. You can search for color, people, animals, loca-



Advanced image search in Google Photos

tion or any other wild object that comes to your mind. Google Photos searches through your gallery using advanced image recognition techniques and search algorithms.

Note: The search term "car" not only returned images of



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Tips & Tricks has its own page numbers, and does not follow the rest of the magazine's page numbers. This is done to ensure that you can cut out and save T&T in a separate folder for later reference.

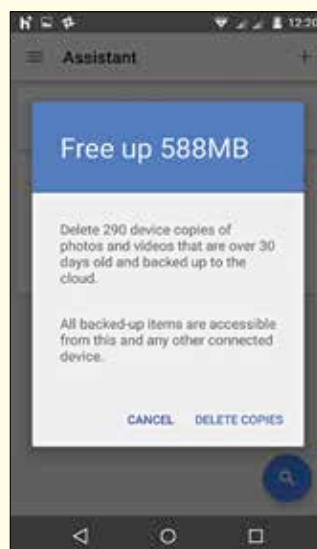
a car, but also of a car engine. Evidently, this application has a powerful AI backend.

Auto-delete local copies

If Google Photos can automatically upload media to the cloud then why can't it automatically delete media from your phone when it's done uploading or you're short of storage? Google Photos can be set to automatically remove images and videos from your smartphone once uploading is finished, hence eliminating identical and redundant copies of the image. But there's a catch: this feature can only be activated if you've set the app to back up "Full original resolution" images. If you've chosen to opt for unlimited storage, Google will compress these images and upload them to the server, hence the local and server copy of the same image won't be identical and Google will consider them as two different images.

The Google Photos app will also prompt you to delete images from your phone whenever you

run out of memory. This feature is helpful especially if you don't care about the resolution and quality of the image. The app



Assistant prompts to delete images in case of low memory

will keep a cached copy of the image in low resolution for quick viewing and save your phone memory.

Pinch to change view

You may assume that the only

function of the pinch-in and pinch-out feature is to zoom in and out of a picture, but there's more to it with Google Photos. By default, the app shows your images in a daily view, with thumbnails arranged chronologically, but there are a number of other options such as monthly view and comfortable view. You can move between the views simply by pinching in or out on your device's screen. You can even pinch in on an image in a view to open it in as an individual image. Regardless of the view, pinching out on a full-screen image will bring you back to the native image list. Swiping up or down on the full-screen image will have an identical effect.

Upload faster using the desktop client

It's preferable to use the desktop client if you are uploading a large number of photos to the cloud. Not only is it hassle-free, but also gives you a coherent upload speed. This option is also preferred if you wish to import images to your computer from a camera or SD card and want them to automatically get backed up to Google Photos when you connect your device

Select multiple photos

Imagine having to select 100 photos from your gallery and tapping on your screen a hundred times. Sounds tedious, right? Here's the hack: while viewing images in the Photos app, long-press on any photo to start selecting the photos. Then, without lifting your finger, drag upward, downward or sideways. This process will allow you to quickly select a series of photos without having to lift your finger. Holding down [Shift] works the same way in the browser client.